

Privacy-Aware Decentralized Optimization

ALTERNATING DIRECTION METHOD OF MULTIPLIERS

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- Formulation
- Decentralization
- Task AoA

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Beyond the Dual and Privacy Amplification

Consensus Problem:

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\substack{x \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times p} \\ z \in \mathbb{R}^p}} \quad & \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n f(x_i; d_i) + g(z) \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & x - \mathbb{I}_{n(p \times p)} z \equiv r = 0 \end{aligned} \quad (1)$$

Parameter updates in the k -th iteration:

$$z^{k+1} := \text{prox}_{\gamma g} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n u_i^k \quad (2)$$

$$x_i^{k+1} := \text{prox}_{\gamma f_i}(2z^{k+1} - u_i^k) \quad (3)$$

$$u_i^{k+1} := u_i^k + 2\lambda \left(r_i^{k+1} + \frac{1}{2} \eta_i^{k+1} \right) \quad (4)$$

Formulating ADMM as a Fixed-Point Iteration:

$$\text{FPI} \oplus \text{IPC} \rightarrow \text{ADMM} : u^{k+1} \equiv T_{\gamma p_1, \gamma p_2}(u^k)$$

$$\text{Lions-Mercier Operator: } T_{\gamma p_1, \gamma p_2} := \lambda(R_{\gamma p_1} \circ R_{\gamma p_2}) + (1 - \lambda)I$$

$$R_{\gamma p_i} := 2 \text{prox}_{\gamma p_i} - I$$



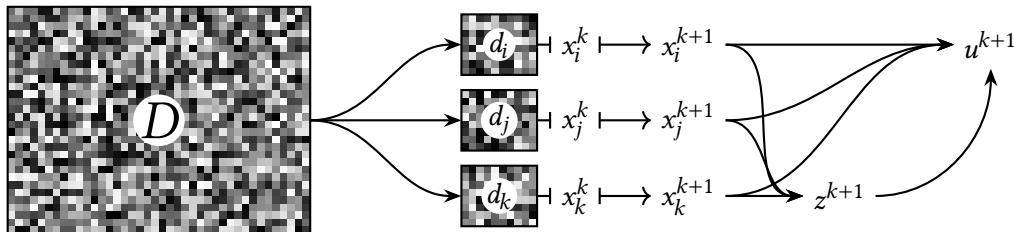
Controlled Decomposition of the Objective

Component separability and block separability

Assuming:

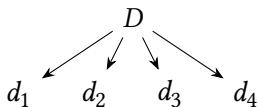
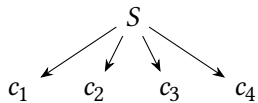
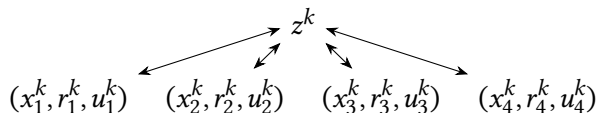
- x can be block-partitioned such that $\bigcup_i^N x_i = x$
- $f(x_0) + f(x_1) + \dots + f(x_{N-1}) \equiv f(x)$

The x -update step can be carried out *in parallel* for all $x_i \subseteq x$.

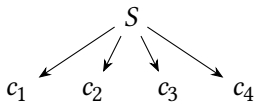


(De)Centralization Schemes

Centralized v. Federated v. Peering



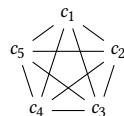
DISTRIBUTED



$\emptyset$

$d_1 \quad d_2 \quad d_3 \quad d_4$

PRIVATE FEDERATED



d_1
 $d_5 \quad d_2$
 $d_4 \quad d_3$

PEERING



An Acceptable Federated Implementation

Objective: Empirical Risk Minimization with Federated RDP-FPI-ADMM

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \mathbb{E}_{d_i \sim D} [f_i(x, d_i)] + g(x) \quad \min_{\substack{x \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times p} \\ z \in \mathbb{R}^p}} \{ \mathbb{E}_{(x, D)} f(x_i; d_i) + g(z) \mid x = \mathbb{I}_{n(p \times p)} z \}$$

- 1 Construct the federated implementation of ADMM (e.g. OpenMPI or simple sockets).
- 2 Establish privacy guarantees (robustness to reconstruction attacks) by leveraging the Rényi Differential Privacy (RDP) (ϵ, δ) -formulation.
- 3 Stabilize optimization by mitigating client drift in heterogeneous (non i.i.d) regimes. Benchmark with various degrees of heterogeneity.
- 4 Implement resource-aware aggregation as opposed to a simple averaging.



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Simulating a Diverse Set of Clients

In federated learning, client datasets may differ in both *mode* and *size*.

- Finding such datasets would be highly non-trivial.
- *Instead, can we effectively simulate this?*



Simulating a Diverse Set of Clients

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- ***Instead, can we effectively simulate this?***

Splitting a Dataset in a Biased Way

- 1 Split a dataset into a number of *modes*, one for each client.
- 2 Sample with *high probability* (many points) from the *modal range*.
- 3 Sample with *low probability* (few points) from the *residual range*, i.e. outside the modal range.
- 4 Randomize the points sampled to make the datasets differ in size.



Non-IID Data Splitting for Regression Datasets

1 Function `RandPop(Array, End, NPoints)`

Input: An array `Array` with $\dim \text{Array} \equiv n \times m$, a right range limit `End` and the number of points to sample `NPoints`.

Output: A *quasi*-random subsample `Sample` of `Array` and `Array` with the elements of `Sample` removed.

2 **assert** $\{\text{End}, \text{NPoints}\} \in \mathbb{N}$

3 **assert** $0 \leq \text{NPoints} \leq \text{End} < n$

4 `Sample` $\leftarrow$ *uniformly sample* `NPoints` *from the range* `Array[0 : End]`

5 `Array` $\leftarrow$ `Array` $\setminus$ `Sample`

6 **return** `Sample, Array`



Non-IID Data Splitting for Regression Datasets

Input: A Dataset **Data**, the column-index of the target **TgtIdx**, the number of splits to produce **Splits**, a “bias factor” **Bias** and a size-randomization toggle **RandSizes**.

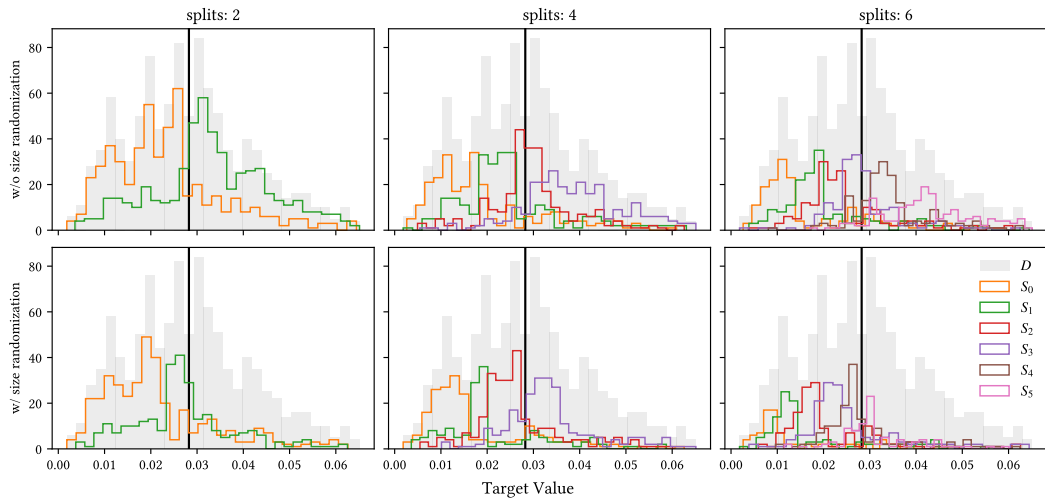
Output: A **Splits**-long hashmap **Hmap** of biased sub-datasets.

```

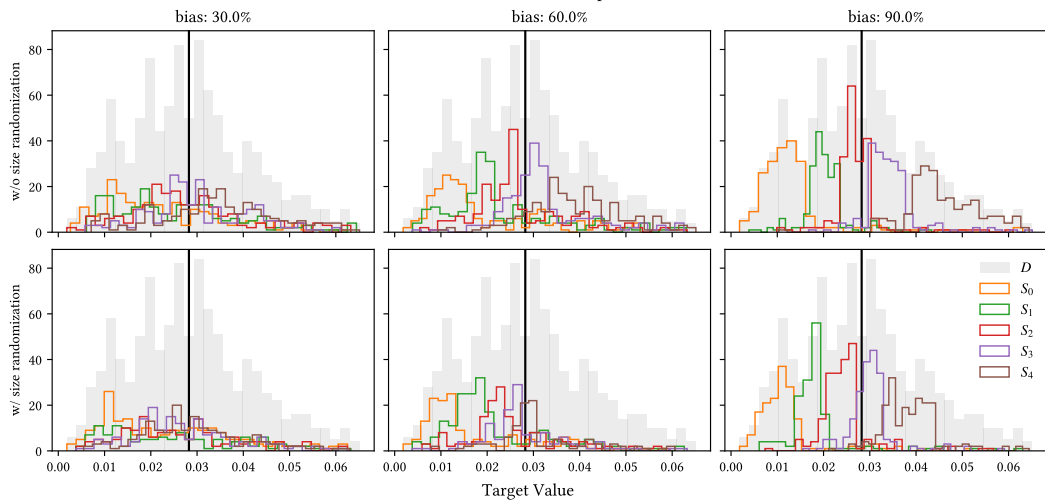
1 Data  $\leftarrow$  SortAscBy(Data; TgtIdx)           /* sort data by target values */
2 for  $0 \leq i < \mathbf{Splits}$  do
3   if RandSizes is True then                     /* rand  $\in [0.5, 1] \vee 1$  */
4     |   rand  $\leftarrow 1 + \mathcal{N}(0, 1)/2$ 
5   else rand  $\leftarrow 1$ 
6   nsplit  $\leftarrow \lfloor \text{rand} \cdot \text{Len}(\mathbf{Data}) / \mathbf{Splits} \rfloor$ 
7   nmode  $\leftarrow \lfloor \mathbf{Bias} \cdot \text{nsplit} \rfloor$ 
8   nrstd  $\leftarrow \text{nsplit} - \text{nmode}$ 
9   Hmap[i]  $\leftarrow$  RandPop(Data, Len(Data), nrstd) :: RandPop(Data, nsplit, nmode)
10 return Hmap
```



Split size influence on data partitions



Bias factor influence on data partitions



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Offering Privacy Guarantees

Client data may be *sensitive* or *confidential*. ***How can we effectively inform them of their potential exposure?***

Cynthia Dwork and Aaron Roth. “The Algorithmic Foundations of Differential Privacy”. In: vol. 9. Foundations and Trends in Theoretical Computer Science 3 - 4. 2014. URL: <https://www.cis.upenn.edu/~aaroht/Papers/privacybook.pdf>.



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Reconstruction Attacks

For a database D with n records, query Q and a response R let $\mathcal{M}_D : Q \mapsto R$ be a mechanism.

$$[\text{DWORK 2014}] \frac{\exists A : \langle \mathcal{M}(Q_1), \mathcal{M}(Q_2), \dots, \mathcal{M}(Q_m) \rangle \mapsto D' \ni \|D' - D\|_1 \in o(n)}{\mathcal{M} \text{ is blatantly non-private}}$$



Pure Differential Privacy

Definition (Differential Privacy)

A randomized mechanism $\mathcal{M} \in \mathbb{N}^{|\mathcal{X}|}$ is (ϵ, δ) -differentially private iff:

$$\|D - D'\|_1 \leq 1, \mathcal{S} \subseteq \text{ran } \mathcal{M} \vdash \Pr[\mathcal{M}_D \in \mathcal{S}] \leq e^\epsilon \Pr[\mathcal{M}_{D'} \in \mathcal{S}] + \delta$$

Abs. Privacy Loss: $\left| \ln \frac{\Pr[\mathcal{M}_D = \xi]}{\Pr[\mathcal{M}_{D'} = \xi]} \right| \leq \epsilon \quad \text{with probability } 1 - \delta$

δ characterizes *catastrophic failure* and must ideally be *negligible*.



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Max Divergence: $D_\infty^\delta(\mathcal{M}_D \| \mathcal{M}_{D'}) := \max_{\mathcal{S} : \Pr[D' \in \mathcal{S}] \geq \delta} \ln \frac{\Pr[\mathcal{M}_D \in \mathcal{S}] - \delta}{\Pr[\mathcal{M}_{D'} \in \mathcal{S}]} \leq \epsilon$

δ characterizes *catastrophic failure* and must ideally be *negligible*.



Necessary Properties of DP Mechanisms

- Protection against arbitrary risks.
- Neutralization of linkage attacks.
- Quantification of privacy loss.
- Composition.
- Closure under post-processing.

Cynthia Dwork and Aaron Roth. “The Algorithmic Foundations of Differential Privacy”. In: vol. 9. Foundations and Trends in Theoretical Computer Science 3 - 4. 2014. URL: <https://www.cis.upenn.edu/~aaroht/Papers/privacybook.pdf>.



Adding Noise to the Responses

For some function f define a randomized mechanism $\mathcal{M} : f(x) + \text{some noise}$.

Laplace Mechanism $\mathcal{M}_L[x, f; \lambda] := f(x) + \Lambda(0, \lambda)$, $\lambda \propto \Delta^p f / \epsilon$.

Gaussian Mechanism $\mathcal{M}_G[x, f; \sigma^2] := f(x) + \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$, $\sigma^2 \propto \Delta^p f / \epsilon$.



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Under the Gaussian Mechanism

- The noise of the dataset is also normally distributed.
- The tails of the Gaussian distribution decay much faster than the tails of the Laplace one.
- Cannot meet ϵ -DP for all ϵ .



Reformulation based on Rényi Divergence

Definition (Rényi Divergence)

For two probability distributions P and Q , the Rényi divergence of order $\alpha > 1$ is:

$$D_{\alpha}(P\|Q) := \frac{1}{\alpha - 1} \ln \mathbb{E}_{x \sim Q} \left[\frac{P(x)}{Q(x)} \right]^{\alpha}$$

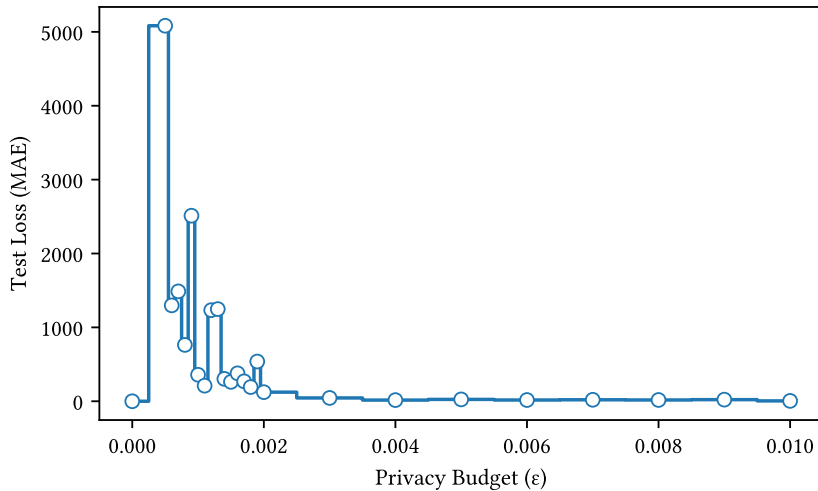
(α, ε) -Rényi Differential Privacy

$$D_{\alpha}(\mathcal{M}_D \| \mathcal{M}_{D'}) \leq \varepsilon$$

$D_{\alpha}(P\|Q) \leq D_{\infty}(P\|Q) \models \text{An } (\alpha, \varepsilon)\text{-RDP mechanism also satisfies } \left(\varepsilon + \frac{\ln 1/\delta}{\alpha-1}, \delta\right)\text{-DP.}$



Performance Impact of Privacy Budget



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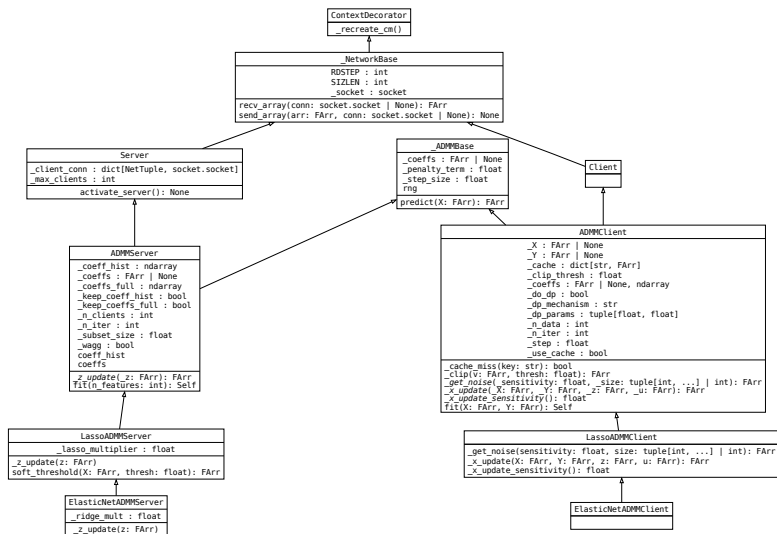
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Server Loop

```

1 Class Server(ElasticNet, ADMM, Net)
2   Function fit(NFeat)
3     foreach  $k$  in clients do
4       | generate weight  $w_k$ 
5     for  $0 \leq i < N\text{Iter}$  do
6       | subset  $\leftarrow$  sample from clients
7       | foreach conn in subset do
8         | Self.send(conn,  $z$ )
9       | while Len(subset) > 0 do
10        | u_update(subset,  $du$ )
11        |  $du \leftarrow du / \text{Len}(\text{clients})$ 
12        |  $z \leftarrow \text{Self.z\_update}(du)$ 
13   return Self
  
```

```

1 Class Server(ElasticNet, ADMM, Net)
2   Function Server(...)
3     | return Self w/ parameters initialized
4   Function u_update(subset,  $du$ )
5     | foreach conn in select(subset) do
6       |  $u \leftarrow \text{Self.recv}(\text{conn})$ 
7       |  $du \leftarrow du + w_k u$ 
8       | subset  $\leftarrow$  subset  $\setminus$  conn
9   Function z_update( $z$ )
10    | return  $\frac{1}{1+2\rho\lambda_2} S_{\lambda_1/\rho K}(z)$ 
  
```



Client Loop

```

1 Class Client(ElasticNet, ADMM, Net)
2   Function fit(NFeat)
3     send server DP-weight data
4     for  $0 \leq i < \text{NIter}$  do
5        $z \leftarrow \text{Self.recv}()$ 
6        $x \leftarrow \text{Self.x\_update}(X, Y, z, u)$ 
7        $r \leftarrow x - z + \mathcal{N}(\Delta^2 f / (2\varepsilon)^2)$ 
8        $du \leftarrow 2\lambda r$ 
9        $\text{Self.send}(du)$ 
10       $u \leftarrow u + du$ 
11    return Self
  
```

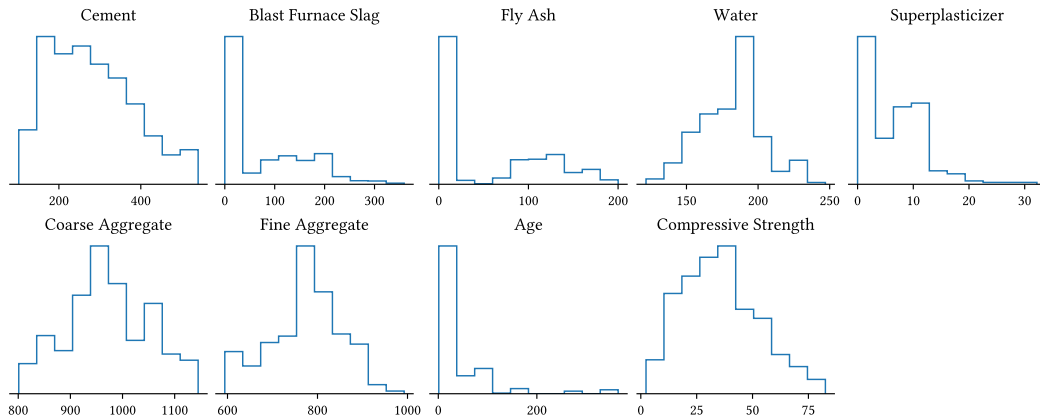
```

1 Class Client(ElasticNet, ADMM, Net)
2   Function Client(...)
3     connect to server
4     initialize cache
5     return Self w/ parameters initialized
6   Function x_update(X, Y, z, u)
7      $l \leftarrow \rho/2$ 
8      $\text{lhs} \leftarrow \text{Self.cache}(X^\top X + \mathbb{I})$ 
9      $\text{xtY} \leftarrow \text{Self.cache}(X^\top Y)$ 
10    return lhs · (xtY + l(z - u))
  
```



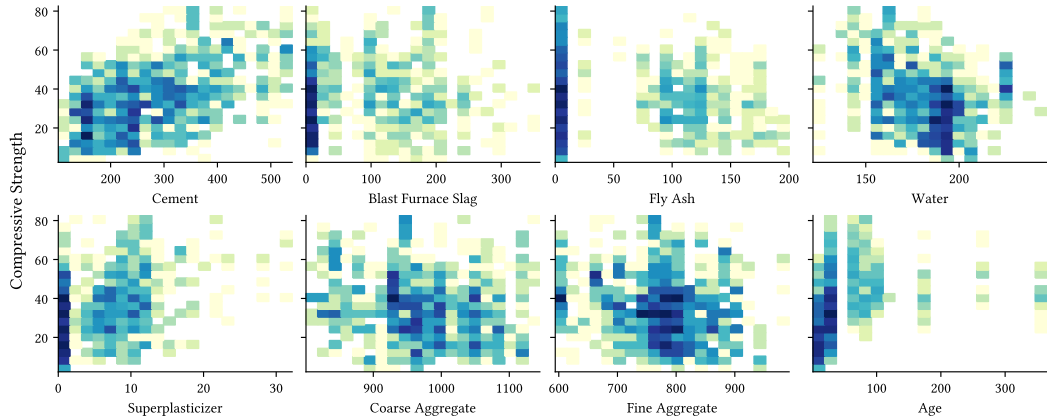
The Concrete Dataset

Feature Distributions



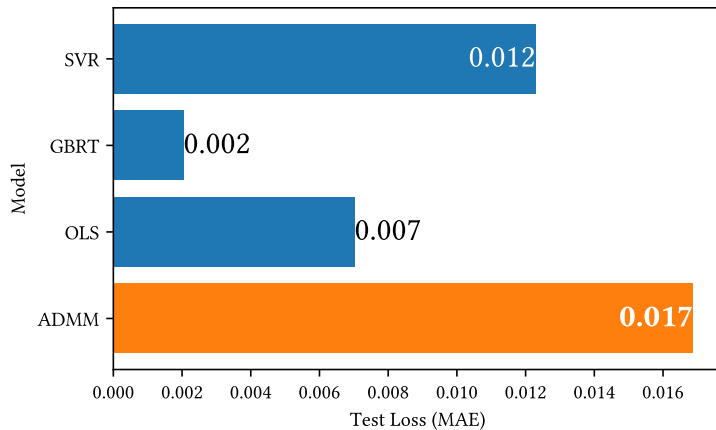
The Concrete Dataset

Feature-Target Correlation



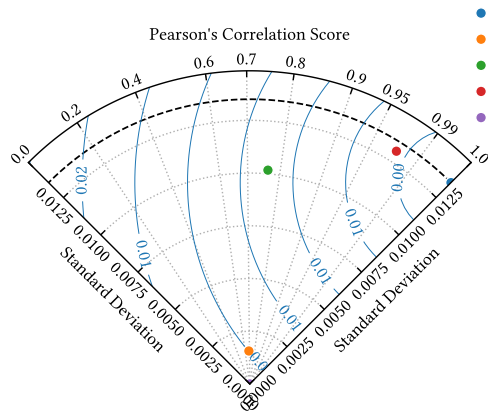
Performance

MAE Scores

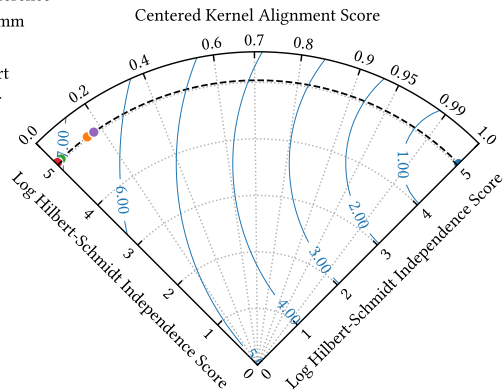


Performance

Taylor Diagrams



- Reference
- admm
- ols
- gbrr
- svr



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